ASTRA VICTORIANS · HOMEWORK

Handwriting warm-up: pothooks and hangers

5 POINTS

Beginners once practised "pothooks and hangers", the curly strokes that letters are made of, before they wrote real words. Trace the grey shapes, then carry on by yourself.

Pothooks

c c c c c c c c c c c c c

Hangers

l l l l l l l l l l l l l l l

Waves and loops

u u u u u u u u u n n n n n n n n

o o o o o o o o o a a a a a a a a

Victorian copperplate letters, to look at and try

a b c d e f g h i j k l m

n o p q r s t u v w x y z

Letter sizes

a c e
m n
o

small letters sit between the bottom line and the middle line

b d
h k
l t

tall letters reach the top

g j
p q
y

letters with tails hang below

Name _____ Date _____ Warm-up

The Owl and the Pussy-Cat

5 POINTS

The Owl and the Pussy-Cat

by **Edward Lear**, 1871, from Nonsense Songs. First verse. Lear drew the pictures himself.

The Owl and the Pussy-Cat went to sea
In a beautiful pea-green boat,
They took some honey, and plenty of money
Wrapped up in a five-pound note.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

Tip: one line at a time, finger spaces between words.

Tall letters touch the top, **tails** hang down.

Name _____ Date _____ Copy

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First trace the grey words. Then write the same line underneath by yourself.

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

Name _____ Date _____ Trace and write

There Was an Old Man with a Beard

5 POINTS

There Was an Old Man with a Beard

by **Edward Lear**, 1846, from A Book of Nonsense. A whole limerick. Count the birds!

There was an Old Man with a beard,
    Who said, "It is just as I feared!
Two Owls and a Hen,
    Four Larks and a Wren,
Have all built their nests in my beard!"

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

Tip: one line at a time, finger spaces between words.

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

Name _____ Date _____ Trace and write

Who Has Seen the Wind?

5 POINTS

Who Has Seen the Wind?

by **Christina Rossetti**, 1872, from Sing-Song. A whole poem in eight short lines.

Who has seen the wind?
    Neither I nor you:
But when the leaves hang trembling
    The wind is passing thro'.
Who has seen the wind?
    Neither you nor I:
But when the trees bow down their heads
    The wind is passing by.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

Name _____ Date _____ Trace and write

What is Pink?

5 POINTS

What is Pink?

by **Christina Rossetti**, 1872, from Sing-Song. The first eight lines. A colour poem.

What is pink? a rose is pink
By the fountain's brink.
What is red? a poppy's red
In its barley bed.
What is blue? the sky is blue
Where the clouds float thro'.
What is white? a swan is white
Sailing in the light.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

Name _____ Date _____ Trace and write

The Swing

5 POINTS

The Swing

by **Robert Louis Stevenson**, 1885, from A Child's Garden of Verses. First verse.

How do you like to go up in a swing,
    Up in the air so blue?
Oh, I do think it the pleasantest thing
    Ever a child can do!

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

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Bed in Summer

5 POINTS

Bed in Summer

by **Robert Louis Stevenson**, 1885, from A Child's Garden of Verses. First verse. Victorian children went to bed by candlelight.

In winter I get up at night
And dress by yellow candle-light.
In summer, quite the other way,
I have to go to bed by day.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

Name _____ Date _____ Trace and write

Rain

5 POINTS

Rain

by **Robert Louis Stevenson**, 1885, from A Child's Garden of Verses. The whole poem.

The rain is raining all around,
    It falls on field and tree,
It rains on the umbrellas here,
    And on the ships at sea.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

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Where Go the Boats?

5 POINTS

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by **Robert Louis Stevenson**, 1885, from A Child's Garden of Verses. First verse. Think of the River Weaver.

Dark brown is the river,
    Golden is the sand.
It flows along for ever,
    With trees on either hand.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

Tip: one line at a time, finger spaces between words.

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How Doth the Little Crocodile

5 POINTS

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by **Lewis Carroll**, 1865, from Alice's Adventures in Wonderland. Alice recites it in Wonderland.

How doth the little crocodile
    Improve his shining tail,
And pour the waters of the Nile
    On every golden scale!
How cheerfully he seems to grin,
    How neatly spread his claws,
And welcome little fishes in
    With gently smiling jaws!

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

Name _____ Date _____ Trace and write

The Star

5 POINTS

The Star

by **Jane Taylor**, 1806, from Rhymes for the Nursery. Written before Victoria, but every Victorian child knew it. First verse.

Twinkle, twinkle, little star,
    How I wonder what you are!
Up above the world so high,
    Like a diamond in the sky.

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

Tip: one line at a time, finger spaces between words.

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- **Draw a picture for the poem**

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Mary Had a Little Lamb

5 POINTS

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by **Sarah Josepha Hale**, 1830, from Poems for Our Children. American, from just before Victoria. First verse.

Mary had a little lamb,
    Its fleece was white as snow,
And every where that Mary went
    The lamb was sure to go;

~ copy it as neatly as you can ~

Tip: one line at a time, finger spaces between words.

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